

PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

Protecting People, Accounts and Organizations from Phishing Attacks

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship — Task 2

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Slide 1 — Introduction

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a form of cyberattack in which an attacker pretends to be a trusted person, company, or service in order to trick a victim into revealing sensitive information or performing an unsafe action.

Attackers may attempt to steal:

- Passwords
- Banking information
- Credit/debit card details
- One-Time Passwords (OTPs)
- Personal information
- Company credentials
- Authentication tokens

Key Message

Think before you click. Verify before you trust.

Slide 2 — Learning Objectives

By the end of this training, participants should be able to:

1. Explain what phishing is.

2. Identify common phishing techniques.
3. Recognize suspicious emails and messages.
4. Detect fake or malicious websites.
5. Understand social-engineering tactics.
6. Identify warning signs in suspicious communications.
7. Apply safe practices when handling links and attachments.
8. Respond appropriately when a phishing attempt is discovered.

Slide 3 — How Phishing Works

A typical phishing attack follows this pattern:

1. Target

The attacker identifies a person or organization.

2. Deception

The attacker creates a convincing email, message, website, or phone call.

3. Delivery

The victim receives the malicious communication.

4. Manipulation

The attacker creates urgency, fear, curiosity, or excitement.

5. Action

The victim clicks a link, opens an attachment, provides information, or transfers money.

6. Exploitation

The attacker uses the stolen information for account takeover, fraud, malware deployment, or further attacks.

Attack chain:

Target → Deceive → Deliver → Manipulate → Victim Acts → Attacker Benefits

Slide 4 — Common Types of Phishing

Email Phishing

Fraudulent emails designed to steal information or deliver malware.

Spear Phishing

Highly targeted phishing directed at a specific individual or organization.

Whaling

Phishing aimed at senior executives or high-value individuals.

Smishing

Phishing conducted through SMS or text messages.

Vishing

Phishing performed through voice calls.

Clone Phishing

A legitimate message is copied and modified to contain a malicious link or attachment.

Business Email Compromise (BEC)

Attackers impersonate executives, employees, suppliers, or business partners to manipulate victims into making payments or revealing information.

Slide 5 — Social Engineering: The Psychology Behind Phishing

Phishing attacks often exploit human emotions rather than technical vulnerabilities.

Common Psychological Triggers

Urgency

"Your account will be suspended today."

Fear

"Suspicious activity has been detected."

Authority

"Your manager has requested this payment."

Curiosity

"See the confidential document attached."

Reward

"Congratulations! You have won a prize."

Trust

"Your bank/security provider needs you to verify your account."

Remember

Attackers manipulate people because people can sometimes be easier to exploit than technology.

Slide 6 — How to Recognize a Phishing Email

Look for these warning signs:

▶ 1. Suspicious Sender Address

The display name may look legitimate while the actual email address is different.

▶ 2. Urgent or Threatening Language

Messages demanding immediate action should be treated cautiously.

▶ 3. Unexpected Attachments

Be careful with unexpected ZIP, HTML, Office, PDF, or executable files.

▶ 4. Suspicious Links

The visible text may not match the actual destination.

▶ 5. Poor Grammar or Formatting

Spelling and grammatical errors can indicate a fraudulent message.

▶ 6. Unexpected Requests

Be suspicious of requests for passwords, OTPs, financial information, or payments.

▶ 7. Too-Good-to-Be-True Offers

Unexpected prizes, refunds, jobs, or financial opportunities may be traps.

Slide 7 — How to Identify a Fake Website

Before entering sensitive information:

Check the URL

Look carefully for:

- Misspelled domain names
- Extra words or characters
- Unusual domain extensions
- Suspicious subdomains
- Shortened links
- Unexpected redirects

Example

Legitimate-looking:

`https://example.com/login`

Suspicious:

`https://example-security-login.example-attacker.com`

The important question is:

"What is the actual domain?"

Do not assume a website is legitimate simply because it contains a company name or has a padlock icon.

Slide 8 — Real-World Example: Fake Microsoft 365 Login

Imagine an employee receives:

Subject: URGENT: Your Microsoft 365 Account Will Be Disabled

Your password has expired.
Verify your account immediately to prevent suspension.
Click below to continue.

[VERIFY ACCOUNT]

Warning Signs

- Unexpected password warning
- Urgent language
- Threat of account suspension
- Login request through an email link
- Possible fake login page

Safe Response

1. Do not click the link.
2. Open the organization's Microsoft 365 portal manually.
3. Verify the account status.
4. Report the message to IT/security.
5. Delete it after reporting.

Slide 9 — Real-World Example: Banking Phishing

Example SMS

BANK ALERT: Your account has been temporarily restricted due to unusual activity. Verify your account immediately using the link below.

Why This Is Dangerous

The attacker may attempt to collect:

- Account number
- Card details
- PIN
- Password
- OTP
- Banking login credentials

What Should You Do?

Do not use the link in the message.

Instead:

- Open your bank's official app.
- Visit the official website manually.
- Contact the bank using a trusted number.
- Report the suspicious message.

Slide 10 — Phishing Attachments and Malware

Phishing does not always require stealing a password.

Attackers may send malicious attachments containing malware.

Examples

- Malicious Office documents
- HTML files
- ZIP archives
- Executable files
- Fake invoices
- Fake CVs

- Fake security reports

Example Scenario

An employee receives:

Subject: Invoice #48291 — Payment Required

Attachment:

Invoice_48291.zip

The employee opens the attachment and unknowingly launches malware.

Best Practice

Never open an unexpected attachment simply because the filename looks legitimate.

Verify the sender through another trusted communication channel.

Slide 11 — Best Practices to Avoid Phishing

STOP

S — Stop before clicking

Do not act immediately.

T — Think

Ask yourself whether the request is expected.

O — Observe

Check the sender, URL, attachment, language, and request.

P — Proceed safely

Verify through an independent trusted channel.

Additional Protection

- Use strong, unique passwords.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Keep operating systems and applications updated.

- Use reputable security software.
- Avoid entering credentials through unexpected links.
- Report suspicious messages.
- Never share passwords or OTPs.
- Back up important data.
- Participate in security-awareness training.

Slide 12 — What To Do If You Clicked a Phishing Link

Do not panic.

Immediately:

1. Disconnect from the network if malware is suspected.
2. Close the suspicious website.
3. Do not enter additional information.
4. Change compromised passwords from a trusted device.
5. Enable MFA if it is not already enabled.
6. Contact your organization's IT/security team.
7. Report the phishing message.
8. Monitor the affected account for suspicious activity.

Important

Fast reporting can reduce the impact of an attack.

INTERACTIVE QUIZ

Slide 13 — Quiz: Spot the Phishing Attempt

Question 1

You receive an email saying:

"Your account will be permanently deleted in 30 minutes. Click here immediately to verify your identity."

What should you do?

- A. Click immediately**
- B. Reply to the sender**
- C. Verify the request through an official channel**
- D. Forward your password**

Correct Answer: C

Urgency and threats are common social-engineering techniques.

Slide 14 — Quiz: Identify the Suspicious URL

Which URL should make you most suspicious?

- A.** `https://company.com/login`
- B.** `https://accounts.company.com`
- C.** `https://company-login-security.example.com`
- D.** `https://company.com/help`

Correct Answer: C

The actual domain is **example.com**, not company.com.

Slide 15 — Quiz: What Would You Do?

Your manager sends a message asking you to urgently purchase gift cards and send the codes.

What should you do?

- A. Buy them immediately**
- B. Ask for the manager's password**

C. Verify the request through another trusted communication channel

D. Send the codes first and ask questions later

Correct Answer: C

This could be an impersonation or Business Email Compromise attack.

Slide 16 — Quick Phishing Detection Checklist

Before clicking, ask:

 **WHO?**

Who sent the message?

 **WHERE?**

Where does the link actually go?

 **WHAT?**

Was the attachment expected?

 **WHY NOW?**

Why is the sender creating urgency?

 **WHAT INFORMATION?**

Why are they asking for credentials, OTPs, money, or personal information?

 **CAN I VERIFY?**

Can I confirm the request independently?

If something feels suspicious:

STOP → VERIFY → REPORT

Slide 17 — Final Takeaways

Remember These Five Rules

1. Don't trust urgency.

Attackers want you to act before thinking.

2. Check the sender.

A familiar name does not guarantee a legitimate sender.

3. Inspect links.

Always verify where a link leads before entering information.

4. Never share credentials or OTPs.

Legitimate organizations should not ask you to disclose sensitive authentication information through suspicious messages.

5. Report suspicious activity.

Reporting quickly can help protect you and others.

FINAL MESSAGE

PHISHING IS NOT JUST A TECHNOLOGY PROBLEM.

It is a human-awareness problem.

Attackers use technology to create deception, but **your awareness is one of the strongest defenses.**

STOP.

THINK.

VERIFY.

REPORT.

Stay alert. Stay informed. Stay secure.

End of Training

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